

15과 고민과 상담

Chapter 15 — Worries and counselling

This chapter at a glance

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문법	Grammar 동-으려던 참이다 / 동-자마자 — I was just about to · the moment something happens
활동	Activities 고민에 대한 조언 구하기, 상담 신청서 쓰기 — asking advice about a worry; filling in a counselling application
문화와 정보	Culture & information 이민자 상담 센터 — counselling centres for immigrants

This is the chapter about asking for help, and it is written for you specifically. The vocabulary names the troubles immigrants in Korea actually report — nationality applications, a spouse's family, Korean that has stopped improving — and the culture page lists the places that will help in your own language, free.

동-으려던 참이다 is 'I was just about to'. It is what you say when someone suggests the very thing you had already decided to do, and it turns up in conversation constantly.

동-자마자 is 'as soon as' — the second thing follows the first with no gap. 외우자마자 잊어버려요, 'I forget the moment I've memorised it', is the complaint that runs through this whole chapter.

도입

Warm-up

이 사람은 무슨 문제가 있어요?

What problem does this person have?

여러분은 힘들 때 누구와 이야기해요?

Who do you talk to when things are hard?

What the original page shows

사진 1

an older woman sitting alone with a hand on her chest, looking troubled

사진 2

a counsellor with a clipboard reaching out to touch the shoulder of a woman sitting with her head in her hands

그림 3

a man at a desk, his thoughts drawn as a tangle of knots above him, while a counsellor stands by taking notes

Note that two of the three pictures show someone already with a counsellor. The page is not asking you to identify distress — it is showing you what getting help looks like, which is the point of the whole chapter.

고민 is a worry you turn over in your mind, and 상담 is a formal consultation about it — with a counsellor, an adviser, a centre. Korean treats 상담 as an ordinary service you go and use, not a last resort.

어휘

Vocabulary — worries and talking them through

여러분은 요즘 고민이 있어요? 어떤 고민인지 이야기해 보세요.

Do you have a worry at the moment? Talk about what it is.

인간관계 문제 — trouble with people

주변 사람들과 가까워지기 어렵다.

finding it hard to get close to the people around you

동료들과 성격이 안 맞는다.

not getting on with colleagues

한국 생활 문제 — trouble with life in Korea

국적 취득이 힘들다.

getting citizenship is hard

한국어 실력이 제자리걸음이다.

your Korean has stopped improving

육아 문제 — trouble with raising children

직장과 육아를 병행하기 힘들다.

hard to manage work and childcare at once

학부모 모임에 참여하기 두렵다.

afraid to go to the parents' association

집안 문제 — trouble at home

고부간의 갈등이 있다.

conflict between a wife and her mother-in-law

부부 싸움을 자주 한다.

the couple argue often

건강 문제 — trouble with health

이유 없이 자주 우울하다.

often low for no reason

만성 피로와 불면증이 있다.

chronic fatigue and insomnia

진로·취업 문제 — trouble with work and direction

진로가 불투명하다.

your path ahead is unclear

퇴직과 이직을 되풀이하고 있다.

leaving jobs and changing jobs over and over

경제 문제 — trouble with money

수입이 일정하지 않다

income is not steady

재테크 및 돈 관리가 어렵다.

saving, investing and managing money is hard

제자리걸음 is 'marking time' — walking on the spot, going nowhere. 한국어 실력이 제자리걸음이에요 is the single most useful sentence on this page for a learner, and it is exactly what the speaking dialogue is about.

고부간의 갈등 — friction between a wife and her husband's mother — is named here as an ordinary category of problem, not a scandal. For married immigrants it is common enough that the 다문화가족지원센터 on the culture page runs counselling specifically for it.

재테크 is 財 (wealth) plus the 테크 of technology: managing and growing your money. It covers saving, investing and budgeting all at once, and it is a word you will hear constantly in Korea.

여러분은 고민이 있을 때 어떻게 해요?

What do you do when something is worrying you?

고민 — being worried

머리가 복잡하다

your head is full, you can't think straight

신경이 쓰이다

it keeps nagging at you

속이 타다

to be eaten up with worry

눈앞이 캄캄하다

everything goes dark in front of you

상담 — talking it over**고민을 털어놓다**

to get a worry off your chest

조언을 구하다

to ask for advice

골치가 아프다

to be a headache, a real nuisance

발 뻗고 못 자다

can't sleep easy

고민을 나누다

to share a worry

상담을 받다

to have a consultation, to get counselling

고민 해결 — getting past it**고민을 덜다**

to lighten a worry

고민을 해결하다

to resolve a worry

고민을 털어버리다

to shake a worry off for good

Most of the first group are idioms about the body, and they cannot be worked out word by word. 속이 타다 is literally 'the insides burn'; 발 뻗고 자다 is 'to sleep with your legs stretched out', meaning to sleep with nothing on your mind, so 발 뻗고 못 자다 is the opposite.

털다 is to shake something out, like a dusty blanket, and it drives three expressions here. 털어놓다 shakes the worry out and puts it down in front of someone; 털어버리다 shakes it off and is rid of it.

문법 1: 동-으려던 참이다

Grammar 1: Verb + -으려던 참이다 — I was just about to

말하는 사람이 가까운 미래에 어떤 일을 하려는 생각을 갖고 있었음을 나타낸다.

Shows that the speaker had been intending to do something in the near future.

선생님 이링 씨, 그 문제는 어떻게 됐어요?
Yiling, what happened with that problem?

이링 아, 안 그래도 잘 해결됐다고 문자를 드리려던 참이었어요.
Oh — I was just about to text you that it's been sorted out.

예문 — Examples

가 점심 안 드실래요? 저는 지금 먹으려고요.
Won't you have lunch? I'm about to eat.

나 같이 먹어요. 저도 마침 점심 먹으려던 참이었는데 잘됐네요.
Let's eat together. I was just about to have lunch myself — perfect timing.

지금 출발하려던 참이었습니다.

I was just about to set off.

친구에게 사과를 하려던 참이었는데 친구가 먼저 미안하다고 했어요.

I was just about to apologise to my friend when they said sorry first.

Which form do I use?

-으려던 참이다 after a final consonant (받침)
먹다 → 먹으려던 참이다 · 앓다 → 앓으려던 참이다

-려던 참이다 after a vowel, and after ㄹ (which stays)
출발하다 → 출발하려던 참이다 · 드리다 → 드리려던 참이다 · ★ 열다 → 열려던 참이다

참 is a noun meaning the very moment, the point at which something stands. So 먹으려던 참이었어요 is literally 'it was the moment at which I had been going to eat'. That is why it is almost always in the past: 참이었다.

Note the starred 열다. With ㄹ verbs the ㄹ stays and you use -려던, so 열려던 참이다 — unlike -을 텐데 and most other endings, where the ㄹ drops. Worth a moment's attention because it goes against the habit.

안 그래도 is its natural companion: 'as it happens, anyway'. 안 그래도 하려던 참이었어요 — 'I was going to do that anyway'. Both example dialogues on this page use it, and together the pair sounds completely natural.

It only works for your own intention, because only you can know it. You cannot say it about someone else's plan.

연습 1 — 보기와 같이 친구와 이야기해 보세요.

보기) 화해하고 싶으면 먼저 사과하세요. — 사과하다

example: if you want to make up, apologise first — to apologise

1) 너무 힘들면 다른 사람에게 도움을 청해 보세요. — 다른 사람에게 도움을 청하다

if it's too much, try asking someone for help — to ask someone for help

2) 그런 문제는 상담을 한번 받아 보면 어때요? — 상담을 받다

why not get some counselling about a problem like that? — to get counselling

3) 건강을 위해서는 운동을 꼭 해야 돼요. — 건강을 위해서 운동하다

for your health you really must exercise — to exercise for your health

4) 늦지 않으려면 지금 출발하는 게 좋을 거예요. — 지금 출발하다

you'd better set off now if you don't want to be late — to set off now

네, 그렇지 않아도 사과하려던 참이었어요.

Yes — I was just about to apologise anyway.

연습 2 — 친한 사람과 텔레파시가 통한 것이 있어요? '-으려던 참이다'를 이용해서 이야기해 보세요.

지갑을 사려던 참이었는데 친구가 지갑을 선물해 줬어요.

I was just about to buy a wallet when a friend gave me one as a present.

문법 2: 동-자마자

Grammar 2: Verb + -자마자 — as soon as

앞의 동작이 이루어지고 난 후에 잇따라 뒤의 사건이나 동작이 일어남을 나타낸다.

Shows that once the first action is done, the second event or action follows immediately.

아나이스 제이슨 씨는 단어 잘 외워져요? 저는 너무 안 외워져요.

Jason, do words stick for you? They just won't stick for me.

제이슨 저도 그래요. 외우자마자 잊어버려요.

Same here. I forget them the moment I've learnt them.

예문 — Examples

가 졸업하면 뭐 할 거예요?

What will you do when you graduate?

나 네, 졸업하자마자 일단 귀국해야 할 것 같아요.

I think I'll have to go home as soon as I graduate.

요즘 너무 피곤해서 집에 돌아가자마자 씻지도 못하고 자요.

I'm so tired lately that I fall asleep the moment I get home, without even washing.

전화로 어머니의 목소리를 듣자마자 눈물이 났어요.

The moment I heard my mother's voice on the phone I started crying.

How it forms

-자마자

one form for every verb

눕다 → 눕자마자 · 외우다 → 외우자마자

No conjugation at all — it goes straight onto the stem, consonant or vowel, with no irregular verbs to worry about. It is one of the easiest endings in the level.

Never put a tense before it. 졸업했자마자 is wrong; it is always 졸업하자마자, whatever tense the sentence as a whole is in. The tense goes on the final verb.

Compare it with -은 후에 and -고 나서, which also mean 'after'. Those simply put the events in order; -자마자 insists there was no gap between them. That immediacy is the whole point.

외워지다 in the opening dialogue is the passive of 외우다: not 'I memorise' but 'it gets memorised'. Korean uses it to say the words won't stick, which shifts the blame off the learner — a kind way to put it, and a common one.

연습 1 — 보기와 같이 친구와 이야기해 보세요.

보기) 월급을 받으면 뭐 해요? — 부모님께 송금부터 하다

example: what do you do when you get paid? — send money to your parents first

1) 집에 돌아가면 뭐 해요? — 텔레비전부터 켜다

what do you do when you get home? — turn the television on first

2) 도착하면 연락하세요. — 전화하다

get in touch when you arrive — to ring

3) 택배를 받으면 전달을 부탁드립니다. — 사장님께 전해 드리다

please pass the parcel on when it arrives — to hand it to the boss

4) 시험이 끝나면 뭐 하고 싶어요? — 여행을 다녀오다

what do you want to do when the exam is over? — to go away on a trip

월급을 받자마자 부모님께 송금부터 해요.

The moment I get paid, the first thing I do is send money to my parents.

명부터 하다 — 'do X first of all'. 송금부터, 텔레비전부터. It pairs naturally with -자마자, because both are about what comes immediately.

연습 2 — 여러분은 집에 가면 무엇을 해요? '-자마자'를 이용해서 이야기해 보세요.

저는 집에 가자마자 강아지를 데리고 산책해요.

As soon as I get home I take the dog out for a walk.

말하기

Speaking

고민이 있는 아나이스 씨가 선배에게 조언을 구합니다. 다음 대화처럼 이야기해 보세요.

Anaïs has something on her mind and asks a senior for advice. Practise a conversation like this.

아나이스 선배, 잠깐 얘기 좀 할 수 있어요?

Can I have a quick word?

선배 어, 안 그래도 커피 한잔하려던 참이었어. 왜? 무슨 일 있어?

Sure — I was just about to get a coffee anyway. What's up?

아나이스 아니, 저 요즘 한국어 실력이 통 늘지 않는 거 같아서요. 단어장도 많은데 외우자마자 금방 잊어버려요. 어떡하죠?

It's just, my Korean doesn't seem to be improving at all lately. I've got plenty of vocabulary notebooks, but I forget the words the moment I learn them. What should I do?

선배 공부를 해도 실력이 안 늘어서 고민이구나.

So you're worried because you study and it still doesn't improve.

아나이스 네, 맞아요. 계속 제자리걸음을 하는 거 같아요.

Yes, exactly. It feels like I'm just marking time.

선배 내 생각에는 무엇보다 꾸준히 하는 게 제일 중요한 것 같아. 매일 연습하고 수업 후에 바로 복습하고.

I think keeping at it steadily matters more than anything. Prepare every day, and review right after class.

아나이스 선배, 좋은 말씀 고마워요. 선배 말씀대로 한번 해 볼게요.

Thank you for the advice. I'll try it your way.

선배 is anyone ahead of you at the same school or workplace, and it is used as a form of address on its own — you call the person 선배, not by name. Note that she speaks politely to him while he replies casually; that asymmetry is normal and not rude.

고민이구나 — the 선배 does not offer advice first; he says back what her problem is. -구나 is the ending for realising something on the spot. Reflecting the worry before answering it is good counselling in any language, and the textbook is modelling it.

예습 is preparing the lesson before class and 복습 is reviewing it after. The two words come as a pair in Korean study advice and you will hear them together constantly.

바꿔서 말하기 — swap these in

1) 단어장도 많은데 외우자마자 금방 잊어버리다

having plenty of vocabulary notebooks but forgetting the words at once

→ 매일 연습하고 수업 후에 바로 복습하다

→ prepare every day and review straight after class

2) 하고 싶은 말이 있어도 자신이 없어서 말을 못 하다

having something to say but no confidence to say it

→ 매일 있었던 일을 일기로 써 보는 것도 좋다

→ try keeping a diary of what happened each day

아래 상황에 맞게 조언을 해 보세요.

Give advice suited to the situations below.

고민 — 한국어 실력이 늘지 않는다.

worry: my Korean isn't improving

고민 — 잠이 잘 안 온다.

worry: I can't get to sleep

조언 — ?

advice: your turn

듣기 · 발음

Listening · Pronunciation

여러분은 취업 상담실에 가 본 적이 있습니까? 취업 상담실 선생님은 무슨 질문을 할까요?

Have you ever been to an employment advice office? What questions would the adviser ask?

어떤 일을 하고 싶으세요?

What kind of work would you like to do?

자격증이나 운전면허증 있으세요?

Do you have any certificates or a driving licence?

급여는 얼마나 받고 싶으세요?

How much would you like to be paid?

취업 상담실 is a real service, not a textbook invention. Job centres, 외국인노동자지원센터 and many 시청 run them, and the three questions here are close to what you will actually be asked.

듣기 — 잠시드 씨와 상담사의 대화입니다. 잘 듣고 질문에 답해 보세요.

1) 잠시드 씨는 지금 무슨 일을 합니까?

What work does Jamshid do at the moment?

2) 잠시드 씨는 왜 이직을 하고 싶어 합니까?

Why does Jamshid want to change jobs?

3) 들은 내용과 같으면 ○, 다르면 X 하세요.

Mark ○ if it matches what you heard, X if not.

① 잠시드 씨는 급여를 일당으로 받고 싶어 한다.

Jamshid wants to be paid by the day.

② 잠시드 씨는 고등학교 졸업 후에 바로 한국에 왔다.

Jamshid came to Korea right after finishing school.

③ 잠시드 씨는 운전면허증이 있다.

Jamshid has a driving licence.

급여 is the formal word for pay, the one used on contracts and in offices; 월급 is the monthly wage and 일당 is a daily rate. Knowing which one you are being offered matters, so learn all three.

단어장

New words

급여 pay, salary · 일당 a daily wage

발음 — 다음을 듣고 따라 읽으세요.

[ㄱ, ㄷ, ㅂ] + [ㄱ, ㄷ, ㅂ, ㅅ, ㅈ] → [ㄱ, ㄷ, ㅂ] + [ㄱ, ㄷ, ㅂ, ㅅ, ㅈ]

After a final ㄱ, ㄷ or ㅂ, a following ㄱ ㄷ ㅂ ㅅ ㅈ is tensed to ㄱ ㄷ ㅂ ㅅ ㅈ.

옆집 [엿집]

ㅍ is pronounced ㅂ at the end, and it tenses the ㅈ to ㅈ

듣자마자 [듣짜마자]

the ㄷ of 듣- tenses the ㅈ of -자마자

먹자마자 [먹짜마자]

the ㄱ of 먹- tenses the ㅈ the same way

This is 경음화, tensing — the most common sound rule in Korean and one that is never written down. Every -자마자 you attach to a stem ending in ㄱ, ㄷ or ㅂ will do this, so the grammar point and the pronunciation point on this page are the same lesson.

It is not the aspiration rule from chapter 16, which needs an ㅎ. Here there is no ㅎ anywhere: a stop consonant simply stiffens whatever follows it.

발음 연습

주차 문제로 옆집 사람들과 사이가 멀어졌다.

We've grown distant from the people next door over a parking problem.

조언을 듣자마자 바로 실천했다.

The moment I heard the advice I put it into practice.

설거지는 미루지 말고 밥을 먹자마자 해야 돼요.

Don't put the washing-up off — you should do it as soon as you've eaten.

읽기

Reading — a depression checklist

다음 건강 문제에 대해서 이야기해 보세요.

Talk about the health problems below.

우울증
depression

불면증
insomnia

고혈압
high blood pressure

당뇨
diabetes

증 marks a condition or disorder: 우울증, 불면증, 건망증. So 우울하다 is to feel low, while 우울증 is the illness. The textbook keeps the two apart carefully, and so should you.

다음의 우울증 체크 리스트를 보고 표시해 보세요.

Look at the depression checklist below and mark your answers.

지난 2주 동안에 — over the past two weeks

전혀 없음
not at all

며칠 동안
several days

1주일 이상
more than a week

거의 매일
nearly every day

1. 매사에 흥미나 즐거움이 거의 없다.

Little interest or pleasure in doing anything.

2. 기분이 가라앉거나 우울하거나 희망이 없다고 느낀다.

Feeling down, depressed or hopeless.

3. 잠들기 어렵거나 자주 깬다. 혹은 잠을 너무 많이 잔다.

Trouble falling asleep, waking often, or sleeping too much.

4. 피곤하다고 느끼거나 기운이 거의 없다.

Feeling tired or having little energy.

5. 식욕이 줄었다. 혹은 너무 많이 먹는다.

Poor appetite, or eating too much.

6. 내 자신이 실패자로 여겨지거나 자신과 가족을 실망시켰다고 느낀다.

Feeling that you are a failure, or that you have let yourself or your family down.

7. 신문을 읽거나 TV를 보는 것과 같은 일상적인 일에 집중하기 어렵다.

Trouble concentrating on ordinary things, such as reading the paper or watching television.

8. 평소보다 말과 행동이 느리다. 혹은 너무 불안해서 가만히 앉아 있을 수 없다.

Speaking and moving more slowly than usual — or so restless that you cannot sit still.

9. 죽고 싶다는 생각을 한다.

Thoughts that you would be better off dead.

This is the PHQ-9, the standard nine-item depression screening questionnaire used worldwide, translated into Korean. It is a real clinical instrument, which is why the wording is careful and why the time frame is fixed at two weeks.

A checklist like this can suggest that it is worth speaking to someone; it cannot diagnose anything. If several items are 거의 매일, that is a reason to see a doctor or a counselling centre, not a verdict.

If item 9 is true for you, please treat it as urgent rather than as homework. In Korea 109 is the free 24-hour

suicide prevention line, and 1577-1366 (다누리콜센터) gives 24-hour counselling in thirteen languages for immigrants and multicultural families. Both are free and neither requires Korean.

읽기 3

Reading 3 — the newspaper article

다음은 신문 기사입니다. 잘 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

The following is a newspaper article. Read it and answer the questions.

마음의 감기, 우울증 자가 진단과 극복 방법 — 'A cold of the mind': screening yourself for depression, and how to get past it

우리는 살면서 어떤 상황이나 사건으로 인해 일시적으로 기분이 우울해지는 것을 경험한다.

In the course of life we all go through spells of low mood brought on by some situation or event.

그러나 쉽게 회복하지 못하고 2주 이상 우울한 기분이 계속된다면 우울증이 아닌지 의심해 볼 수 있다.

But if it does not lift easily and the low mood carries on for more than two weeks, you may suspect depression.

우울증은 마음의 감기라고도 하는데 실제로 열 명 중 한 명은 우울증에 걸린다고 보고될 정도로 흔한 병이다.

Depression is sometimes called a cold of the mind, and it is common enough that one person in ten is reported to suffer from it.

한국건강증진개발원은 우울증 자가 진단법을 소개하고 "우울증은 다른 모든 질병과 마찬가지로 빨리 발견하여 치료하는 것이 중요하다."라고 덧붙였다.

The Korea Health Promotion Institute introduced a self-screening method and added that "with depression, as with any other illness, what matters is finding it early and treating it."

우울증은 조기 진단과 치료가 중요하기 때문에 증상이 의심되면 빨리 병원을 찾거나 지역 정신 보건 기관에서 상담을 받아 보는 것이 좋다.

Because early diagnosis and treatment matter, if you suspect the symptoms it is best to see a doctor quickly or get counselling at a local mental health service.

'정신건강위기상담전화'(1577-0199)를 통해 전화 상담을 받을 수도 있다.

You can also get telephone counselling through the mental health crisis line, 1577-0199.

세계보건기구(WHO)는 우울하다고 느낄 때 ▲믿을 수 있는 사람과 자신의 감정을 이야기하기 ▲술·담배 피하기 ▲짧은 산책이라도 규칙적으로 운동하기 ▲가족·친구와 관계 및 연락 유지하기 등을 극복 방법으로 권하고 있다.

The World Health Organization recommends, when you feel low: talking about your feelings with someone you trust; avoiding alcohol and tobacco; exercising regularly, even if only a short walk; and keeping up contact and relationships with family and friends.

마음의 감기 — 'a cold of the mind' — is a deliberate piece of public health language. Calling it a cold makes it ordinary and treatable rather than shameful, and it is the standard Korean phrase for lowering the barrier to seeking help.

About the number in the article: 1577-0199 was the mental health crisis line and still connects to regional mental health centres. Since 2024 the single national line for suicide prevention has been 109, free and 24 hours. For counselling in your own language, 1577-1366 (다누리콜센터) runs 24 hours in thirteen languages.

Grammatically the article is worth reading twice. 보고되다, 의심하다, 권하고 있다 are all newspaper register, and ▲ is how Korean papers set out a list inside running text where English would use bullet points.

질문 — Questions

1) 윗글의 중심 생각은 무엇입니까?

What is the main idea of the article?

① 누구나 우울증에 걸릴 수 있다.

Anyone can get depression.

② 우울증은 노력하면 쉽게 극복할 수 있다.

Depression is easy to overcome if you try.

③ 우울증은 빨리 발견하여 치료하는 것이 중요하다.

What matters with depression is finding it early and treating it. → the answer

④ 자가 진단법을 통해 우울증을 정확하게 진단할 수 있다.

Self-screening can diagnose depression accurately.

2) 윗글의 내용과 같으면 ○, 다르면 X 하세요.

Mark ○ if it matches the article, X if not.

① 기분이 우울한 것을 모두 우울증이라고 한다.

Any low mood is called depression. → X (2주 이상 계속될 때)

② 살면서 90%의 사람이 우울증을 경험한다.

90% of people experience depression. → X (열 명 중 한 명)

③ 우울할 때는 사람들과 자주 만나거나 연락하는 것이 좋다.

When you feel low it is good to see and contact people often. → ○

단어장

New words

일시적 temporary · 의심하다 to suspect · 보고되다 to be reported

쓰기

Writing — a counselling application

요즘 여러분의 고민은 무엇입니까?

What is on your mind at the moment?

무엇에 대한 고민입니까?

What is the worry about?

어떤 문제가 있습니까?

What is the problem?

그 고민을 해결하기 위해 어떤 노력을 해 봤습니까?

What have you tried in order to resolve it?

다음은 고민 상담 신청서입니다. 신청서를 작성해 보세요.

Below is a counselling application form. Fill it in.

고민 상담 신청서 — Counselling application

신청 일자 — 20 년 월 일

date of application — year, month, day

성명

full name

성별 — 남 / 여

sex — male / female

이메일

email

전화번호

telephone number

국적

nationality

상담 언어

language you want the session in

주소

address

고민 유형 — type of problem

인간관계 문제

relationships

취업 문제

finding work

진로 문제

career direction

집안 문제

family and household

건강 문제

health

경제적 문제

money

육아/자녀 교육 문제

childcare and children's schooling

기타 ()

other

고민 상담 내용 — what you would like to discuss

상담 언어 is the field that matters most to you, and it is on the real forms too. Filling in your own language is not an admission of weak Korean — the centres employ interpreters precisely so that you can explain a difficult thing properly.

For the free-text box, the chapter has given you the shape: name the problem, say what you have already tried, then ask. 요즘 한국어 실력이 제자리걸음이어서 고민입니다. 매일 단어를 외우지만 외우자마자 잊어버립니다.

문화와 정보: 이민자 상담 센터

Culture & information — counselling centres for immigrants

한국에 이민자가 증가하면서 이민자들의 문제를 해결해 주거나 상담해 주는 기관도 늘고 있다.

As the number of immigrants in Korea has grown, so has the number of bodies that help solve their problems or offer counselling.

이민자를 위한 상담 기관은 한국에 살면서 겪는 어려움을 상담해 주거나 구체적인 해결 방안을 마련해 준다.

These services talk through the difficulties of living in Korea and work out concrete ways to resolve them.

이민자를 대상으로 한 상담 센터는 지역별로 여러 곳이 있지만 대표적인 예로 '외국인노동자지원센터'가 있다.

There are many such centres region by region, but the best-known example is the Migrant Workers' Support Centre.

'외국인노동자지원센터'에서는 한국에 거주하고 있는 외국인 노동자들의 문제를 그들의 모국어로 상담해 준다.

There, foreign workers living in Korea are counselled about their problems in their own mother tongue.

또한 서울에는 '서울글로벌센터'에서 이민자들을 위한 다양한 서비스를 제공하고 있는데, 상담도 그중의 하나이다.

In Seoul, the Seoul Global Center provides a range of services for immigrants, counselling among them.

특히 생활과 관련된 문제를 상담해 주거나 취업 관련 상담도 운영하고 있다.

In particular it advises on everyday problems and also runs employment counselling.

이외에도 각 지방 자치 단체에 설치되어 있는 '다문화가족지원센터'에서는 결혼 이민자를 대상으로 가족 상담을 진행하고 있다.

Beyond these, the Multicultural Family Support Centres set up by each local authority run family counselling for married immigrants.

These three are worth writing down, because between them they cover most of what goes wrong.

외국인노동자지원센터 for anything to do with your job, wages or employer; 다문화가족지원센터 for family matters if you came through marriage; 서울글로벌센터 for everyday life in Seoul, including visas and housing.

모국어로 상담해 준다 is the part to notice. The counselling is in your own language, not in Korean, and it is free. Not knowing enough Korean is never a reason to stay away.

Two numbers to keep in your phone: 1345 is the Immigration Contact Center, which answers questions about visas, residence and daily life in around twenty languages; 1577-1366 is the Danuri call centre, 24 hours, thirteen languages, for immigrants and multicultural families.

Questions

1) 외국인 노동자들을 대상으로 한 상담 센터는 무엇입니까?

→ '외국인노동자지원센터'입니다

2) 결혼 이민자 가족을 대상으로 한 상담은 어디에서 받을 수 있습니까?

→ 각 지방 자치 단체의 '다문화가족지원센터'에서 받을 수 있습니다

3) 여러분 주변에 이민자를 대상으로 한 상담 센터로 무엇이 있습니까?

→ What counselling centres for immigrants are there near you?

배운 어휘 확인

Vocabulary checklist

배운 어휘 확인 — everything this chapter taught

인간관계

relationships with people

성격이 안 맞다

not to get on, to clash

국적 취득

acquiring citizenship

제자리걸음

marking time, going nowhere

병행하다

to do two things at once

두렵다

to be afraid

고부간

between a wife and her mother-in-law

불투명하다

to be unclear, uncertain

되풀이하다

to repeat over and over

만성 피로

chronic fatigue

불면증

insomnia

일정하다

to be steady, regular

재테크

managing and growing your money

머리가 복잡하다

your head is full

신경이 쓰이다

it keeps nagging at you

속이 타다

to be eaten up with worry

골치가 아프다

to be a headache

눈앞이 캄캄하다

everything goes dark in front of you

발을 못 뺀고 자다

to sleep uneasily

고민을 털어놓다

to get a worry off your chest

고민을 나누다

to share a worry

조언을 구하다

to ask for advice

상담을 받다

to get counselling

고민을 덜다

to lighten a worry

고민을 해결하다

to resolve a worry

고민을 털어버리다

to shake a worry off for good

급여

pay, salary

일당

a daily wage

우울증

depression

고혈압

high blood pressure

당뇨

diabetes

일시적

temporary

의심하다

to suspect

보고되다

to be reported

Chapter 16 is the last of level 3 after this one. If any of the words on the left half of this list describe you at the moment, the culture page two pages back is the practical answer to them, and it is free.